



In waters off Kaafu Atoll in the Maldives, structures are installed to break up eroding waves while allowing the flow of currents that accumulate sand and sediment.

How A.I. Aids In Rebuilding Sandy Shores

By QUINN GLABICKI

As the world’s oceans grow ever warmer and the seas rise ever higher, coastlines are retreating at a record pace. And with the rising tides, thousands of coastal communities are at risk. The United Nations warns that as many as 1.2 billion people could be displaced by 2050.

But in the Maldives, a low-lying archipelago in the Indian Ocean, researchers are doing something remarkable: They are growing beaches.

The project, born in a laboratory at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology a decade ago, uses artificial intelligence, satellite and ocean current data to predict coastal erosion patterns and create submerged structures that harness currents to coax the beach back.

The company, Coastal Assembly, has regrown the sandy shore, extending the beach some 90 feet toward the ocean along a stretch about 300 feet long. A second project built a new sandbar with more than 30,000 cubic feet of sand in just six months, stirring hope that there may be a way to slow the disappearance of coastal societies.

In the turquoise waters off Kaafu Atoll, the company’s automated intelligence analyzed 10 years of satellite imagery, currents and other data to predict erosion patterns. The company then designed and installed 54 structures cast from marine concrete blended with sand and crushed shells, arranged in a row of hexagons. The structure is specially designed to break up erod-

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African Hotel Is Hellish Prison for U.S. Deportees

By MEGHA RAJAGOPALAN and PRANAV BASKAR

Two men deported to Equatorial Guinea by the Trump administration were hooded, bound, beaten with guns and shoved down a flight of stairs recently by police officers at a remote hotel where immigrants are being held indefinitely, according to witnesses and lawyers.

The deportees said the beatings and subsequent arrests were intended to stop them from telling the outside world about the deteriorating conditions and growing violence inside the hotel, which has become a de facto prison for 29

Exiled Far From Home in a Nation Lax on Human Rights

men and women from different countries.

Experts and human rights advocates predicted such abuse after the Trump administration began deporting people to authoritarian countries where they had no ties or, in many cases, legal rights. Equatorial Guinea, like other countries cooperating with the U.S. deportation program, is notorious for human rights vio-

lations, including torture and arbitrary arrest, according to the State Department.

Equatorial Guinea, an autocracy on Africa’s western coast, is one of many nations that have agreed to accept immigrants deported from the United States. With no legal status, the deportees are being held in the Hotel Bamy, a dilapidated building on the outskirts of the city of Malabo. Armed police officers stand guard 24 hours a day and frequently harass and intimidate people there with impunity, deportees said.

“We are in imminent danger now and can’t keep living like this,” Ahmed Soliman, a deportee

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FERNANDO FACIOLE/NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC/HANDOUT, VIA REUTERS

Tigrino’s True Stripes: Bigger Spots

The first newly discovered feline species in a century is smaller than a house cat. Page A6.

Rise of GLP-1s Leaves Food Industry Holding the Party-Size Bag

By JULIE CRESWELL

In the spring of 2024, weighing 210 pounds and on medication to reduce his blood pressure, Dan Sherry was prescribed Ozempic.

Today Mr. Sherry, 58, weighs 160 pounds and his blood pressure is under control. He bikes daily and his waist is six inches smaller.

One of the biggest changes to his lifestyle has been his eating habits. Mr. Sherry, a nurse who

lives in Holland, Mich., eats out less frequently, and when he does go out with friends, he drinks less alcohol and typically eats only half of his meal. He eats fewer French fries than he once did.

At the supermarket, he puts more meat and protein shakes in his cart while a bag of Cape Cod Sea Salt & Vinegar chips has become “a rare splurge.”

The growing use of GLP-1s is reshaping consumer behavior and

Grocery Bills Shrinking, Just Like Waistlines

shopping patterns across a multitude of industries. But perhaps no sector faces as sweeping a transformation from the weight-loss drugs as does the food industry.

“My grocery food bill is probably 10 to 15 percent less,” Mr.

Sherry said. “The biggest spending was on new clothes.”

For decades, companies have relied on growth by successfully encouraging people to eat more. In stores, consumers filled grocery carts with buy-two-get-one-free offers. Chips were sold in “party” size and cookies in “family” size portions. Consumers sipped soda from Big Gulps and in some restaurants could super-

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Trump Eyeing Business Pacts With Moscow

By ANTON TROIANOVSKI

WASHINGTON — When President Trump’s envoys sat down with Vladimir V. Putin at the Kremlin this month, the Russian leader exuded confidence.

Within months, he said, Russian troops would finally capture Ukraine’s entire Donbas region. And Russia was poised to pummel Ukraine’s electricity grid, setting the stage for a miserable winter.

Then one of the envoys, Jared Kushner, tried to push back. With all due respect, you told us exactly that a year ago, Mr. Kushner said to the Russian president. What are the chances we come back here in another year and you are again saying the same thing? Maybe we don’t lose a year?

The exchange, described by a person familiar with the talks and by a U.S. official, captured the quandary of Mr. Trump’s more than 18 months of efforts to end the war in Ukraine.

Congress this week passed a landmark sanctions bill aiming at Russia’s energy sector, a new attempt to make Russia “suffer” for its invasion and to pressure Mr. Putin to make compromises.

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NEWS ANALYSIS

Attorney General’s Politicking Batters Post-Watergate Values

By CHARLIE SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — Attorney General Todd Blanche has repeatedly participated in campaign events and spoken in partisan terms about the coming midterm elections since his confirmation last month, despite criticism that he violated a longstanding Justice Department principle of steering clear of electoral politics.

This week he waded again into those waters — twice.

Since August, Mr. Blanche has come under fire for making campaign-tinged public appearances and comments. Last month, at a rally-style event on Long Island, he praised Bruce Blakeman, the Republican candi-

Norm of Independence Is Being Dismantled

date for governor of New York. Last week, Mr. Blanche delivered remarks at the Republican Party’s midterm convention.

On Tuesday, he stood at the White House podium and disparaged Democratic lawmakers while invoking the coming elections, dismissing their concerns about artificial intelligence as “nothing but an effort to influence the midterms.”

And on Wednesday, Mr. Blanche spoke at a campaign rally for Michael Whatley, the

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9

F.B.I. Lashed Out at Canada

The abrupt move by Kash Patel, the bureau’s director, came as President Trump was ramping up his attacks on the country. PAGE A9

Nigerians Packed Into Cell

Thirty-seven miners died in custody, officials said. Two survivors said the cell had barely any ventilation. PAGE A7

SPORTS B7-10

A Nomadic Champion

Winning is all that matters to Lane Kiffin, the L.S.U. coach, which could be why he often changes jobs. PAGE B7



BUSINESS B1-6

4 Ways to Save on Gadgets

Popular consumer technologies aren’t getting any cheaper. Yet there are ways to beat “techflation.” PAGE B1

Buffett Resigns as Chairman

Warren E. Buffett, who turned Berkshire Hathaway into an investing powerhouse, will remain on the board. PAGE B1

NATIONAL A10-17

Deadly Drug Hits San Francisco

City officials, and one determined mother, are working to stop the spread of cychlorphine, which is far more potent than fentanyl. PAGE A10

Clancy Jury Holdout Speaks

Michael P. Desronvil defended his decision not to join other jurors in voting for an acquittal. PAGE A15

TRAVEL C7-9

So Much Coastline to Explore

A road trip along the North Shore of Lake Superior can pack several adventures into a single week. PAGE C7

ARTS C1-6

Energetic and All Over Town

The New York Philharmonic’s season started with a barnstorming tour of Manhattan to celebrate Gustavo Dudamel’s arrival as the orchestra’s music and artistic director. PAGE C1

A Countercultural Vision

For several decades, the bold colors and benign peace-and-love message of the artist Peter Max, who died on Monday at 88, captivated those who saw America shining. PAGE C1

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MAGAZINE



THIS WEEKEND

